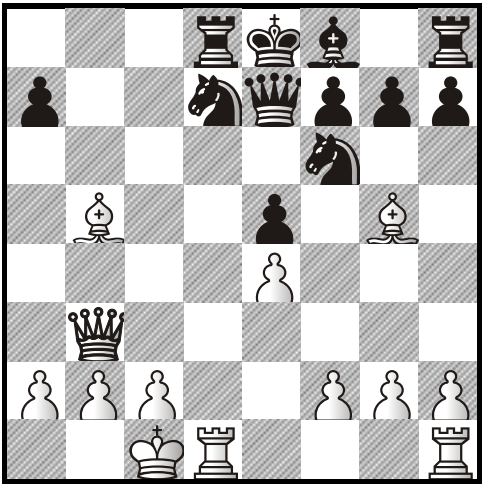
Chapter 1 The Open Games

Our first example is one of the best known games ever played. It shows rapid development and the power of open lines.

Morphy – Duke of Brunswick and Count Isouard, Paris 1858

1.e4 e5 2.♘f3 d6 3.d4 ♗g4?! This pin is premature. Instead 3...exd4 4.♕xd4 is a quieter line.

4.dxe5 ♗xf3 5.♕xf3 dxe5 6.♗c4 ♘f6 7.♕b3 ♕e7 8.♘c3 c6 9.♗g5 9...b5 (9...♕b4 10.♗xf6 ♕xb3 11.♗xb3 gxf6 was better.) **10.♘xb5 cxb5 11.♗xb5+ ♘bd7 12.O-O-O ♖d8**

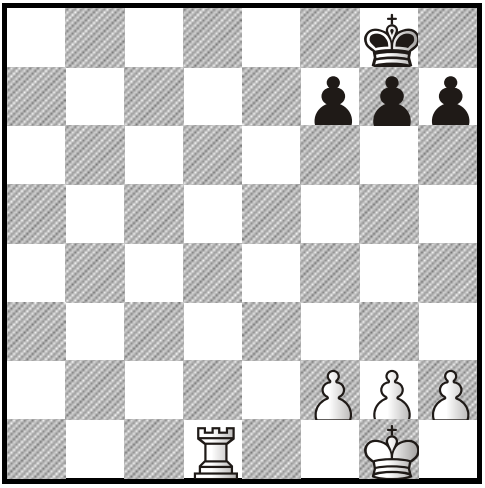


The position after 12...♖d8

13.♖xd7 ♖xd7 14.♖d1 ♕e6 15.♗xd7+ ♘xd7 16.♕b8+ ♘xb8 17.♖d8# 1–0

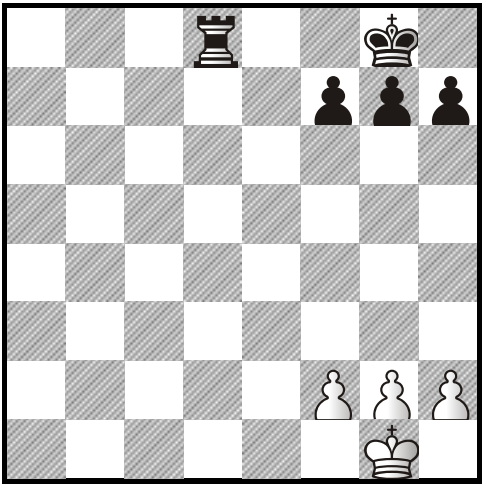
Chapter 2 Back-Rank Combinations

A king without an escape square on the back rank is a classic target.



White to move

1.♖d8# ends the game at once.



Black to move

1...♖d1# is the mirror image.

Game 3. Lopez – Garcia, Madrid 1575

1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7 and the players agreed a draw. 1/2-1/2

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